Armenian opponents would get fired up was an ironic reference to his major nationality problems at home.

Finally, both the Gorbachevs revealed something of themselves during the evening. Evidently true lovers of the ballet, they recalled fondly how they had watched standing from the upper balconies in their student days. Gorbachev noted that his only two connections with religion had been his baptism which he could not remember and a recent meeting with Soviet church leaders. His comment that he had never used his law degree brought out a strong defense of his successes in life from Raisa. She also remarked to you on the responsibilities and burdens of leadership. Both expressed a confident sense of national pride in their descriptions of the variety of the Soviet Union, remarks which came across to me as genuine and not overbearing.

In sum, Mr. President, the evening was a fitting climax to your four summits with General Secretary Gorbachev. O'Bie and I were honored to take part.

There were many high points of our visit to Moscow, one of them being when I stopped the car so Nancy and I could take a walk in Red Square at midnight, on the way back from dinner at the Gorbachevs' dacha. Gorbachev and I had been there earlier in the day, when we chatted informally with a group of Muscovites, and I was so taken with it that I wanted to take Nancy there. Another high point was a night at the Bolshoi Ballet with the Gorbachevs. From the moment we walked into that famous hall, we were overwhelmed by its beauty. Resplendent in gold and red, richly detailed and elegant, the magnificence of the hall was surpassed only by the grace and elegance of the dancers. I knew the world was changing when we stood with the Gorbachevs in our box, with the Soviet flag on one side and ours on the other, and "The Star-Spangled Banner" was played. To hear that